Keyboard Only

What is it for?

Keyboard only is a method for navigating the web using just a keyboard (not using the mouse at all). Many people with disabilities navigate using only the keyboard, but some users without disabilities also navigate using the keyboard for speed and efficiency.

Many people navigate using their keyboard only, but it's especially important for the following people:

- People with motor skills disabilities
- People who struggle with fine motor control
- People with tremors
- People with little to no use of their hands (or no hands at all)
- People with visual impairments

How to support it

Make sure that all interactive elements (buttons, links, etc.) can be navigated to using the keyboard, and that all interactivity still functions as expected. The focus should also be clear: if your focus is on a button, can you tell that's where your focus is just by looking?

To test keyboard accessibility:

1. On page load, don't click anywhere. If you've already clicked, click in the top left corner of the page
2. Press `Tab` to tab through the page
3. `Shift` + `Tab` will tab backward
4. `Enter` should function as a mouse click does
5. By default, `Space` scrolls a page, if an interactive control that allows `Space` input is not focused

Test keyboard accessibility on mobile devices as well, as users with disabilities often use an external keyboard with phones and tablets.

Useful links

- WebAIM: Keyboard accessibility
- MDN: Keyboard accessible
- How to Enhance Accessibility with Keyboard-only Navigation